



Browser Releases

Mozilla Firefox 3.1 beta 2 public preview available for download. Opera 10 beta likely to be available by April.

Web slices

Simply put, a Web Slice is essentially an RSS feed for a web site. The thought being that you would rather quickly glance at information some web sites put out, instead of visiting that site every time you need an update. Weather report, stock updates, and auction alerts make for some of the Web Slices available. Once again, you can add third-party Slices to IE8: a web site which has a Web Slice to offer will cause an icon to pop-up under IE8 (similar to the RSS feed discovery icon that shows up in all modern browsers) – clicking this icon will add the Web Slice to IE8.

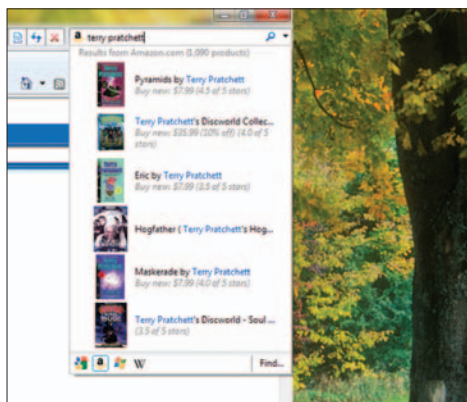
A Web Slice keeps you updated without the need to visit a web site. This particular Slice lists the top stories on Digg



If a Web Slice is available, a green icon appears in the upper right corner

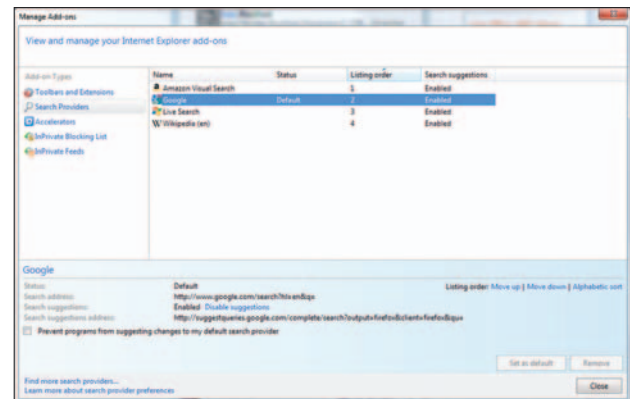
Search enhancements

IE8 offers a couple of features to make internet searches friendlier. When you type a keyword in the browser's search field, it offers real-time search suggestions. Moreover, you can add multiple engines to the browser (notably, not a new feature) and triggering a search through any of these added engines is just a matter of clicking on the correct icon. Apart from suggestions, IE8 also offers a so-called Visual Search. Visual Search, as the name suggests, offers a

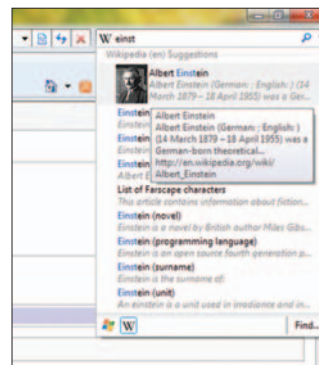


Visual search using the Amazon engine

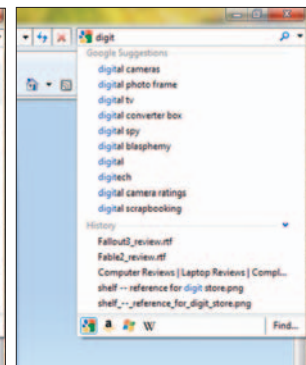
visual result to a query – for example, typing in 'new delhi weather' will offer a peek at the current weather conditions in the capital. Visual Search results are through third-party tie-ups: currently Wikipedia, Amazon, Yahoo!, and some weather services offer Visual Search results but one can expect future additions to this list.



Managing Add-ons and Search Providers. Note that you can also change the order in which the search engines are listed



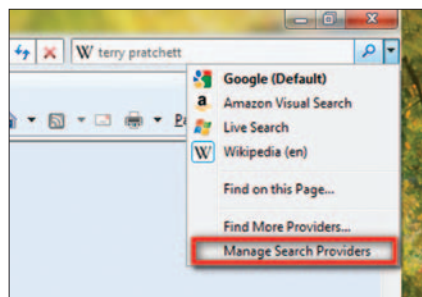
Visual Search shows you instant previews of your search results



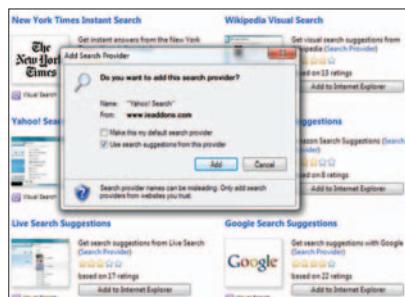
IE Search also goes through your History. Note the different Search providers at the bottom



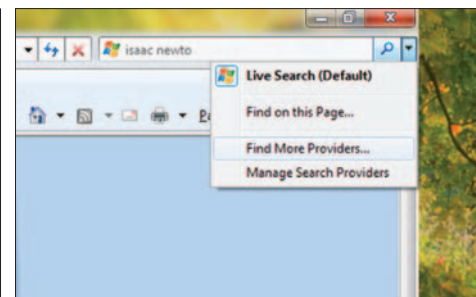
Note that you can press [Shift] + [Enter] to launch the first result, and that you can remove a result if you don't think it's relevant



Delete, disable, or enable Search Providers



Changing search providers is a simpler process



Add more providers for Visual Search